Afterkeep

EXECUTOR'S DIGITAL CHECKLIST

What to do in the first 30 days

In the first 30 days, an executor should secure the person's devices, find any legacy plan they left, list their accounts, save irreplaceable photos and files, and then use each platform's official deceased-user process. Request data before closing accounts, and check whether probate is needed.

☐	**Days 1–3**	Get several certified copies of the death certificate (or the interim document your state provides).
☐	**Days 1–3**	Secure their phone, laptop and tablets. Keep them charged; don't factory-reset anything yet.
☐	**Days 1–3**	Look for a plan: password manager emergency access, an Apple Legacy Contact access key, a Google Inactive Account Manager email, and a list of accounts.
☐	**Days 1–7**	Find the will and confirm who the executor is. If there's no will, find out who can apply to be administrator.
☐	**Days 1–7**	Don't log in with their password unless a lawyer says it's OK; many platform terms forbid it.
☐	**Week 1**	List every account you can find: email, cloud storage, socials, banks, PayPal, crypto, domains and subscriptions.
☐	**Week 1**	Download or preserve irreplaceable photos and files first, through official legacy tools or deceased-user requests.
☐	**Week 2**	Use each platform's official deceased-user process. Request data before asking for closure.
☐	**Week 2**	In Australia, use the free Australian Death Notification Service to notify participating organisations.
☐	**Weeks 2–4**	Cancel or pause paid subscriptions to stop charges.
☐	**Weeks 2–4**	Memorialise or close social media accounts (Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn, X) according to the family's wishes.
☐	**Weeks 2–4**	Check whether asset holders need probate or letters of administration, and start the application with your state's Supreme Court if they do.
☐	**Day 30**	Record what's done, what's pending and every reference number. Keep copies of everything you sent.

Notes and reference numbers:

Official sources (checked 15 Oct 2026):

- Australian Death Notification Service: https://deathnotification.gov.au/
- Apple: Request access to a deceased family member's Apple Account: https://support.apple.com/en-us/102431
- Google: Submit a request regarding a deceased user's account: https://support.google.com/accounts/troubleshooter/6357590
- ATO: Checklist: what to do when someone dies: https://www.ato.gov.au/individuals-and-families/deceased-estates/checklist-what-to-do-when-someone-dies

Afterkeep is an independent guide directory. General information, not legal advice. afterkeep.github.io/guides/what-to-do-when-someone-dies-digital-checklist/